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Targeting a ‘blue law’ that limits hunting

As deer population and diseases increase, governor proposes ending Sunday ban

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

Drinking was forbidden. As was cussing, card games, and anything else that could get in the way of going to church. Today, they are known as the “blue laws,” the hold-over Puritan prohibitions that barred all sorts of activities on Sundays if the fun police saw them as a barrier to getting people into the pews.

Many of those laws are now the

stuff of history books. In 1983, the state finally allowed stores to open on Sundays. In 2003, it gave the package stores the go-ahead as well. And now, thanks to legislation announced by Governor Maura Healey, there is real momentum to take another one off the books and allow hunting on Sundays.

“Hunting is one of our oldest traditions, and it’s still thriving,” Healey said Thursday at a press conference at the Frances A. Crane

Wildlife Management Area in East Falmouth, where she made the announcement.

“One of the funky things about Massachusetts is we have these ‘blue laws’ that go back to the Puritan times,” Healey said. “We stopped burning women at the stake, and allow people to drink alcohol. But we still have a ban on Sunday hunting. It doesn’t make any sense.”

It’s something generations of hunters have lobbied for — arguing

the ban essentially halves the days that working stiffs can get into the woods — but it has remained in place thanks to strong opposition in a state where less than one percent of residents hunt. As the opposition argument goes, having one day a week to go into the woods without hunters present is not too much to ask.

Healey’s move comes at a time when MassWildlife, the state agency

25-50

The amount of deer per square mile in Eastern Massachusetts

HUNTING, Page A7

ICE agents at airports drawing concerns

Deployment assisting TSA set to begin Monday as way to trim wait times

GLOBE STAFF AND NEWS SERVICES

WASHINGTON — President Trump’s decision to order federal immigration agents to US airports to help with security during a budget impasse is drawing concerns that their presence may escalate tensions among air travelers frustrated over hourslong waits and screeners angry about missed paychecks.

Trump made it clear on Sunday that he was going ahead with the plan to have immigration enforcement officers assist the Transportation Security Administration by guarding exit lanes or checking passenger IDs unless Democrats agreed to fund the Department of Homeland Security. Democrats are demanding major changes to federal immigration operations and showing no sign of backing down.

Union officials representing TSA workers in New England said Sunday they had received no formal indication that ICE agents will be sent to local airports.

“We have not heard anything official from TSA leadership that ICE would be coming to any airport in New England,” said Michael Gayzarian, president of AFGE Local 2615, which represents TSA officers in New England. “However, we are making inquiries.”

New England airports have so far avoided the

AIRPORTS, Page A5

‘Once you’re in the match, you forget about everything that’s around you.’

CHRISTIAN FIGUEROA, a sophomore wrestler at East Boston High School



Takedowns and rising up

For the first time, Eastie High had a wrestling team. Its cadre of athletes found in each match a chance to learn about the sport — and themselves.

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

HOLLISTON — That Saturday started before sunrise for East Boston High School’s fledgling wrestling team, a scrappy band of nine teenagers who boarded a bus and headed west into the suburbs, chasing a shot at the state tournament.

They strode into the gym wearing their worn, royal blue hoodies, proud to be breaking ground as the Eastie Jets’ first wrestling team in the school’s 146-year history. Just a few months ago, they didn’t know much about the sport and now they were competing in section-



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Top, Pedro Acosta worked to keep his shoulder off the mat during a match at Holliston High School. Above, Lucca Casasanta (right) laced up his shoes.

als.

It didn’t matter that they were about to face athletes from decades-old wrestling programs. Or that they didn’t have custom warm-up jackets like the ones worn by the more established teams. Or that their parents couldn’t make the 35-mile drive to cheer them on.

These kids had the type of coaches who always found a way to do more, like raising money on a GoFundMe page to cover expenses and order those fancy jackets. The message they sent the team was clear: Be kind, do your best, and represent the

WRESTLERS, Page A10

Fight ignites on how much pot to allow in R.I.

Officials consider reducing licenses, angering many

By Steph Machado
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — In Rhode Island, there could soon be a pot shop in a former Pizza Hut, an abandoned dry cleaners, or even where Benny’s used to be. One business owner hopes to open a cannabis store in a historic building in Providence’s financial district, while another is pitching an old bingo hall in Pawtucket.

The 97 applicants who want to open Rhode Island’s first recreational-only marijuana shops are eyeing locations from Woonsocket to Westerly, hoping to cash in on an industry that, until now, has been open to few.

But nearly four years after the state legalized marijuana and set the wheels in motion to open 24 stores, state officials are considering changing course by potentially licensing fewer retailers — at least at first — as some fear Rhode Island could face the same problems as Massachusetts if too many stores open too fast. Massachusetts, which does not limit the total number of licenses issued for selling or growing, is considering a licensing freeze amid over-saturation and price drops of 70 percent.

CANNABIS, Page A10

In the news

The United States and Iran swapped threats over targeting critical energy infrastructure as their war imperiled lives throughout the Middle East. **A4.**

The Supreme Court is about to hear arguments over mail-in ballots, a case that could affect voting in several states. **A2.**

University groups praised a ruling by a federal judge in Boston that allows a lawsuit over canceled visas to proceed. **B1.**

A proposal by Tennessee lawmakers could have broad local implications for CVS, while offering a test nationally of how far lawmakers might be willing to go to rein in pharmacy benefit managers. **D1.**

Fading parchment a portal to harsh past

MBTA operator discovers rare ‘freedom paper’ that kept ancestor from enslavers

By Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

Aaron Haynes gets choked up when he thinks about what the faded piece of parchment represents: a lineage spanning centuries, and most importantly, his ancestor’s freedom from enslavement.

Haynes, who works as an operator on the MBTA’s Green Line, began exploring his family genealogy this winter after finding an original freedom paper belonging to one of his ancestors. The documents were proof that an African American person was free in the years before slavery was abolished. Without the papers, individuals risked being kidnapped and unlawfully sold into slavery.

Haynes’s ancestor’s document, issued in 1834, was passed down through generations to his grand-

DOCUMENT, Page A7



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Aaron Haynes found the document while cleaning his mother’s hutch.



Slip service

Monday: Early flurry, then rain. High 36-41, low 29-34.

Tuesday: Sun pops out. High 41-46, low 31-36.

Sunrise: 6:42. Sunset: 7:00.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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